

Eric Kennedy

Product-minded software engineer specializing in applied AI, distributed systems, and backend infrastructure. I thrive in ambiguous problem spaces: turning early product ideas into production systems, designing the architecture, shipping quickly, measuring outcomes, and owning reliability as usage scales.

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1M+ Annual customer interactions powered by AI systems I helped build	\$25M+ Measured business impact from AI matching and optimization	Stealth → \$159.8M annual revenue Helped scale Ethos from stealth through hypergrowth during my tenure
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LANGUAGES & TECH

- TypeScript
- JavaScriptPython
- GolangJava
- PostgresReact
- CSSKubernetes
- TerraformDocker
- KafkaRedis
- AWSSSQS
- SNSRDS
- PyTorch
- OpenSearch
- Vector Search
- Embeddings
- Next.jsTailwind
- SQLAlchemy
- FastAPIExpress
- KoaMuxGin
- StripeCloudinary
- OAuthDebezium
- AvroDatadog
- SplunkArgo CD
- GitHub Actions
- pganalyze

FOCUS & STRENGTHS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE



Intuit

2024 - Present

Senior Software Engineer | intuit.com

- Virtual Expert Platform:** Built AI-powered marketplace, recommendation, and real-time workforce optimization systems for Intuit's Virtual Expert Platform, powering TurboTax Live, QuickBooks Live, Find a ProAdvisor, QuickBooks Accountant, and QuickBooks Payroll. During tax peak, 5 days before April 15, contact-management systems served **4.2M customers across 26k experts**.
- AI matching:** Built and led an **AI co-pilot matching platform** using transcript analysis, embeddings, and agentic workflows. Scaled AI-driven matching from 0.2% to **36% of contact-center traffic** across **1M+ yearly interactions**, reduced onboarding from 3-6 months to **under 4 hours**, and delivered **\$11.4M in 2025 plus \$14M in 2026** business impact. Patent filed.
- Automated routing:** Re-architected matching to run fully automated and human-out-of-loop, generating personalized expert assignments at customer contact time. Built a Kafka stream processor handling 3K+ messages/second; recovered from a peak-season failure affecting **45% of contact volume** and delivered **\$3.3M in savings**.
- Agent gateway:** Led a hosted **AI agent gateway** with 20+ domain agents for onboarding, expert availability, routing rules, enterprise permissions, and contact-center operations. Built the shared runtime, access control, tool integration, collaborative sessions, and interfaces across web UI, Slack, Claude Code, and service APIs. Platform eliminated **thousands of hours** of manual ops work with **90+ weekly active users**.
- Transcript analysis:** Built a Bring Your Own Prompt transcript-analysis platform for arbitrary LLM queries over thousands of customer conversations, used for tax policy compliance detection with **95.5% precision**, QA at scale, and expert skill gap analysis.
- Observability:** Spearheaded obs-as-code (Terraform/IaC for observability) to colocate Splunk-style alert definitions next to code, improve LLM codegen leverage, and make observability part of the deploy process.
- Reliability:** Diagnosed and fixed a production memory leak that cascaded from heap OOM to consumer-thread exit, blocking queue deadlock, and pod failure. Root-caused via heap dumps, thread dumps, and Prometheus; implemented graceful shutdown and rollback handling for Kubernetes SIGTERM to prevent in-flight data corruption.

Applied AI systems and agent platforms

Event-driven platform architecture

Postgres, data modeling, and migrations

Kubernetes, deploy automation, and observability

PORTFOLIO LINKS

AI contact-center matching

AI agent gateway

Event bus architecture

AnimePics project

EDUCATION

Northwestern Economics, 2014

Bradfield CS Databases, Networks, Computer Architecture, Deep Learning, 2018



AnimePics

2023

Founder | AnimePics project

- **Product:** Created a **GenAI product** that transformed user photos into anime illustrations using diffusion deep learning and custom models.
- **Frontend:** Implemented a mobile-first frontend with TypeScript, Next.js, Tailwind, Zustand, and React Query.
- **Backend:** Engineered a Python backend with Starlite, SQLAlchemy, Postgres, S3, Redis, Kafka, and PyTorch GPU workers for durable orders, media storage, caching, and async GPU job orchestration.
- **Payments and auth:** Integrated Cloudinary media management, Stripe payments, Google OAuth, Apple OAuth, passwordless email, and guest checkout.



Ethos

2018 - 2023

Staff Software Engineer | ethoslife.com

- **Early engineer:** Joined pre-launch as Ethos's 3rd engineer and built major frontend and backend systems that became core company infrastructure. Helped scale Ethos from stealth to **\$159.8M 2023 revenue, \$50M ARR, and 100+ engineers**. Held the highest IC level and mentored ICs into engineering managers.
- **Infrastructure migration:** Migrated ECS to Kubernetes with **100% uptime** and introduced Datadog observability; migrated Mongo to Postgres to improve integrity through schema-on-write and transactional controller logic.
- **Deploy automation:** Built deploy automation: GitHub Actions created ECR tags, a React admin UI mapped commits to tags, a Golang service created deployment PRs, and Argo CD shipped the merge. Reduced deploy time from **about 5 hours to about 5 minutes**.
- **Event platform:** Created an **event-sourcing system** that evolved from SQS to custom Golang Postgres CDC to SNS/SQS with JSON Schema, then Debezium to Kafka with Avro; handled **50,000+ events per day**.
- Owned deep platform and data-system work across service boundaries, persistence, frontend performance, and production operations:

Service boundaries: identified monolith domains, wrote ERDs, and created 20+ Kubernetes services.

Postgres/RDS: owned monitoring, PIT snapshots, reserved instances, Terraform modules, extensions, pganalyze, and Multi-AZ.

Frontend performance: implemented caching, cross-subdomain CORS/cookies, Nginx asset caching, and redirect reduction.

Backend performance: added Redis middleware caching and a Kubernetes operator for CDN invalidation on image changes.

Data modeling: shipped no-downtime migrations and refactored polymorphic relations to exclusive arc.

Query optimization: fixed an **O^n payments query** from **4 hours to 5 seconds**.

Incident response: served as final escalation point for major on-call incidents across the platform.

Curology | Fullstack Engineer

2017 - 2018. Built an in-browser photo editor with canvas, D3, RxJS, and mobile drag and drop; hundreds of photos created weekly. Created photo metadata APIs for product and analytics.

hiQ Labs | Lead Frontend Engineer

2015 - 2017. Built paginated employee directory, AWS upload/download, and KPI dashboard pages; improved builds with Webpack, Babel, PostCSS, minification, and gzip.